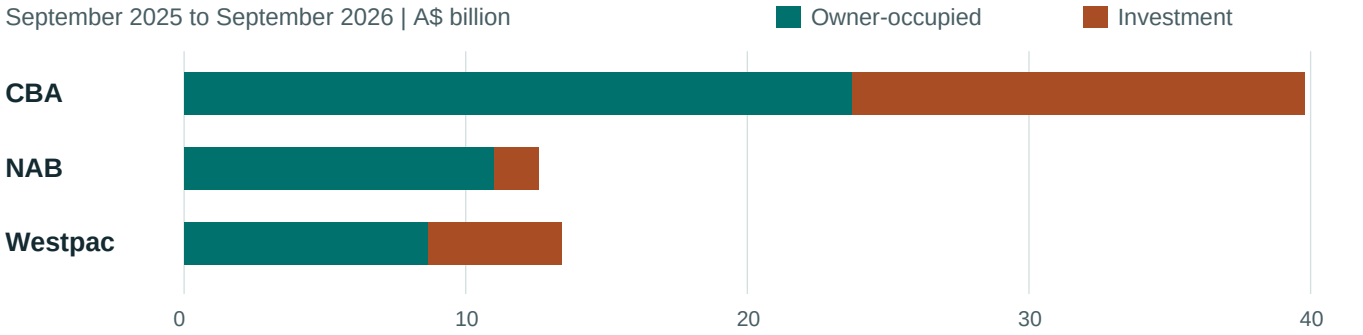
BANKING ANALYTICS

Three Australian bank mortgage cases

Jiahui Zhang | CBA, NAB and Westpac | September 2026

Housing loan balances rose 4.59% across the three banks. They added A$65.8bn in the year to September 2026, with CBA accounting for 60.5% of the increase. The three banks showed different growth patterns by loan purpose.

Where each bank's balance growth came from



CBA | Fastest growth. Investor balances rose 7.75%, faster than owner-occupied balances (6.00%). CBA added A$16.1bn of investor loans on a net balance basis, the largest increase of the three.

NAB | Owner-occupied growth dominated. Owner-occupied balances rose 4.90%, versus 1.38% for investor balances. The investor share fell 0.76 percentage points.

Westpac | Similar growth across purposes. Owner-occupied balances rose 2.66% and investor balances rose 2.87%. The investor share changed by less than 0.1 percentage point.

Cross-bank comparison

Bank	Sep 2026 balance	Annual growth	Investor share	Share of growth
CBA	A$642.9bn	+6.60%	34.74%	60.5%
NAB	A$351.0bn	+3.72%	32.78%	19.1%
Westpac	A$505.3bn	+2.73%	33.78%	20.4%
Three banks	**A$1,499.1bn**	**+4.59%**	**33.96%**	**100.0%**

Combined. Owner-occupied balances added A$43.4bn and investor balances added A$22.4bn. Each segment grew about 4.6%, leaving the combined investor share nearly unchanged.

Scope. APRA domestic books for the three named legal entities, not their consolidated groups or the full market. Growth uses starting balances as weights in the combined row. Share of growth uses the three banks' net increase as the denominator. Balances are stocks: they do not identify originations, refinancing flows or borrower switching.